

Session 7 Summary Meeting Notes

Date: Monday, June 23, 2026 · 10:00 AM – 2:00 PM

Location: Southampton · Mitchell's house

Confidential · Arkay Succession Planning

Latest · Session 7

Meeting notes — June 23, 2026

Meeting purpose: Accountability check-in on strategic initiatives and operational progress following Session 6 commitments.

Key takeaways

- **CTO hired (consultant start):** Steve — former Navy nuclear commander with AI master's — will join as consultant ("date before we marry") to unify AI, ERP, and robotics strategy. Michael Dercksen to finalize terms.
- **Healthcare costs cut:** Switching to captive insurance (Aetna admin) saves ~\$300K annually vs. Cigna's 12.5% hike. Employee rates unchanged; Aug 1 go-live.
- **Critical CapEx approved:** \$70K HHS glueline upgrade approved for immediate install. \$200K air compressor upgrade deferred to Q4.
- **Staffing & overtime:** Blue line goal 95 staff (currently 83/106). OT at \$40,174 last week, down from \$60K. Monthly production bonus program launches Aug 1.
- **Technology:** ERP consultant decision by end of July; AMS AI proof of concept due July 31; ESCO modernization cost/timing analysis led by Brian & John Sheridan.

- **Sales & customers:** P&G account transition to Josh & Michael Prince by end of 2027; "P&G Bible" to document strategy. Sol de Janeiro moving from China; Triple Z volume 5–7M units.

Technology and ERP strategy

- CTO candidate evaluation underway — leadership role managing teams, not hands-on coding; open to Roanoke relocation for robotics expansion.
- ERP requires external consultants (\$20K–\$200K scope); project manager targeted by week of July 20.
- AMS AI proof of concept in progress — July 31 deadline; positive results could delay full ERP implementation.
- Warehouse Wi-Fi upgrade (~\$7K) planned before robotics deployment.
- ESCO Global Vision licensing extended for Roanoke automated proofreading (<\$20K); ESCO modernization analysis before next meeting.

Sales, marketing & customer engagement

- Pipeline growth in supplements and oral care; potential 123M unit deal with holographic stamping.
- Marketing rebranding driving inbound leads; plan to replace agency with internal/freelance marketing manager post-October.
- Suzanne training for Sol de Janeiro by January 2025; Michael & Amanda managing P&G with junior transition planned.
- HubSpot CRM adoption and Dale Carnegie public speaking training for sales team.

Operations and production efficiency

- Pressman recruitment (Joe Thomas + new candidate) to fill shifts on 418, 419, 420, 421 and reach three-shift operation.
- Bell system and weekly huddles improving shop floor discipline and accountability.
- Proofing checklist requiring sales sign-off before proofs proceed — four-week turnaround target.
- Closeout meeting reports identifying patterns; Max Katz report optimizing rate standards.
- 48-hour locked schedule pilot continuing; cold foil measurement tracking.

HR, staffing & finance

- Glue line staffing improving — nine new hires oriented; goal 95 employees for three shifts.
- Wes Reynolds leaving in 45 days; Mike Worley training as second-shift supervisor.
- Nico role clarified — remains on Josh's team for new business, not structural design.
- MK Holdings mortgage refinance with First Citizens closing imminently.
- \$1.1M capex budget approved including QR machines and equipment upgrades.
- Angie (warehouse manager) delegation mentoring by John Sheridan.

Action items & next steps

Mitchell Kaneff

Documentation updates with Grace for completed agenda items	Ongoing
AI consent signatures — NY employees with Robin	ASAP
MK Holdings mortgage signing for closing	Immediate
Pressman recruitment & bonus program rollout	Aug 1
Marketing freelancer hiring with Robin	Post-October
CTO candidate evaluation oversight	July

Michael Dercksen

Finalize consulting terms with Steve (CTO)	July
HubSpot implementation budgeting	30 days
ERP consultant selection — Ultra meeting week of Jul 20	End of July
Production bonus program launch	Aug 1
Healthcare captive transition with Marsh McLennan	Aug 1
Sustainability cost report (one page)	30 days

Josh Kaneff

Lead HubSpot training while Mitchell is out	July
Freelance Sales & Marketing Manager job description	30 days
P&G account transition planning with Walt	Through 2027

John Sheridan

ESCO modernization cost/timing analysis with Brian	Before next meeting
Approve \$70K HHS glueline upgrade	Immediate
Train new pressmen; third-shift build	30 days
Max immersion & estimating training Jul 27	Jul 27
Angie delegation mentoring	Ongoing
Wes Reynolds succession plan	45 days

Robin Rivera

AI consent forms collection	ASAP
Marketing freelancer screening	Post-October
Written warning — Hunter Goldman attendance	Immediate
Glue line temp-to-perm conversions (up to 3)	30 days

Max Kaneff

Structural design & estimating training	Aug 1
AMS proof of concept participation	Jul 31
ERP decisions with Ultra consultants	Jul 20 week

Brian Hopkins

Operational exposure & leadership transition	Ongoing
ESCO modernization analysis with John	Before next meeting

Walt Shiels

Create "P&G Bible" — negotiation history & strategy	30 days
P&G account transition to Josh & Michael Prince	End of 2027